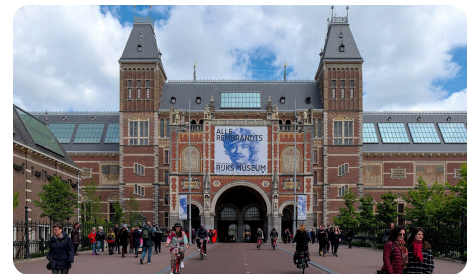




✈️ LIGHT AMSTERDAM → FLY HOME

Prepared for Divyansh · Pure-Vegetarian Edition · Europe 2026



 **17** Saturday, 5 September 2026 · Day 18 · Amsterdam → Mumbai

Solo · Pure Vegetarian · Base: Amsterdam central hostel (last morning)

Today in one line: Keep it LIGHT — a gentle Amsterdam morning, souvenirs, one final veg lunch, then a calm, well-timed exit to Schiphol for the evening non-stop home. **The whole day protects the 20:35 flight.**

 **VISA — HARD DEADLINE, ZERO BUFFER.** Your Schengen visa is exactly 18 days: entered Aug 19, must **exit today, Sep 5**. This evening's flight IS your exit. **There is no margin. Do not miss it, do not risk it.** If anything runs late, cut the sightseeing — never the flight.

WAKE & LEAVE

- **~08:00–08:30** — Wake, no alarm-panic. Slow last morning.

- **~09:30 — Checkout** (know your hostel's checkout time, usually 10:00–11:00). Do it early, then leave bags in **hostel luggage storage** so you roam hands-free. Confirm storage is available today and note its **last-access / closing time**.
-  **16:45 — THE ANCHOR: grab bags from storage**. Non-negotiable. Set an alarm. If you're enjoying something at 16:30, wrap it up.
- **~17:00** — Train Amsterdam Centraal → Schiphol (~15 min) to be at the airport by **~17:30 = ~3h before the flight**.

HOUR-BY-HOUR

Time	What	Notes
~08:30	 Relaxed breakfast	Slow morning
~09:30	 Checkout → bags to luggage storage	Confirm storage + closing time
~10:00	 Chill Amsterdam — canal walk, souvenirs	Hands-free
~10:30	 Albert Cuyp Market	Fresh stroopwafels, souvenirs, veg snacks
~11:30	 A'DAM Lookout (optional)	Free ferry behind Centraal; Europe's highest swing
~12:30	 Nine Streets shopping / canal café / brown bar	Last souvenirs
~13:00	 Final veg lunch	De Bolhoed / The Vegan Indian / Foodhallen
~14:30	Anything missed — Vondelpark, canal-side sit	Keep it low-key
16:45	 Grab bags from storage	Non-negotiable
~17:00	 Train Centraal → Schiphol	Tap OVpay, ~15 min
~17:30	 At Schiphol (3h before)	Bag drop, exit passport control, security
20:35	 Non-stop departs → Mumbai	Evening IndiGo
~09:20 (Sep 6)	 Arrive Mumbai (BOM)	+1 day

LAST-MORNING PICKS (all optional — choose a few)

-  **A'DAM Lookout + "Over the Edge" swing** — Europe's highest swing, out over a tower on the north bank. Free **ferry from behind Centraal** (~2 min). Best skyline view + a thrill; quick.
-  **Albert Cuyp Market** (De Pijp) — Amsterdam's biggest street market. **Stroopwafels made in front of you**, cheese, souvenirs, veg snacks. Best last-minute gifts.
-  **Nine Streets (De 9 Straatjes)** — the prettiest little canal shopping lanes; the definitive Amsterdam stroll, one last time.

- 🍷 **Brown café / canal-side sit** — a cozy Dutch pub (bruine kroeg) or a bench by the water; a no-agenda goodbye.
- 🌳 **Vondelpark** — easy green stroll if you want calm before the airport.

Keep it genuinely light — the goal is a stress-free exit, not to cram.

🥗 VEGETARIAN FOOD

- **Breakfast** — hostel or a café (Dutch breakfast, stroopwafels, coffee).
 - **Albert Cuyp snacks** — fresh **stroopwafels**, **poffertjes**, fries, fruit.
 - **Final veg lunch (~13:00):**
 - **De Bolhoed** — cozy canal-side vegetarian, lovely last meal
 - **The Vegan Indian** — familiar comfort before the long flight
 - **Foodhallen** — indoor food hall, lots of veg options
 - **Eat a solid lunch** — flight dinner is later; don't board hungry.
 - **At Schiphol** — grab a veg sandwich + water after security for the wait. You have the pre-ordered veg meal onboard, but carry a **backup snack**.
-

🚆 TRANSPORT TO SCHIPHOL

- **Train: Amsterdam Centraal → Schiphol Airport** — **~15 minutes**, frequent (several per hour).
 - **Cost ~€5–6 one-way. Tap contactless / OVpay** at the gates (same as trams — no paper ticket needed): tap in at Centraal, tap out at Schiphol.
 - Schiphol's train station is **inside the airport** — you arrive right under the terminal.
 - **Buffer:** leave Centraal by ~17:00 so a missed train still lands you at Schiphol by ~17:30.
Around town all day: walk / tram / **free GVB ferries** behind Centraal — all OVpay contactless.
-

✈️ AIRPORT — SCHIPHOL TIPS

- 🕒 **Be there by ~17:30 (3h before).** Non-EU (India) passport control + **exit stamping** + security take time; Schiphol is huge and busy on a Saturday evening. Visa exit day — do NOT cut it close.
- 🛂 **Get your Schengen exit stamp** at passport control — your proof you left within the visa window. Keep the boarding pass afterward.
- 📱 **Web check-in done + QR boarding pass saved offline** (screenshot). It's ✅ **booked** — QR ready.

- 🍽️ **Confirm the pre-ordered veg meal** (Asian veg / Hindu veg) is attached to your booking. Backup snack in the bag.
 - 📄 **Non-stop** — no connection to manage. One flight straight to Mumbai.
 - 🛃 **Tax refund (Global Blue / Planet):** if you bought pricey souvenirs and got **tax-free forms** from the shop, Schiphol has a **VAT-refund desk / customs stamp point** — get the customs stamp **before** security/check-in with the goods available, then refund at the desk. If you didn't collect tax-free forms while shopping, there's nothing to claim — skip it and don't lose time.
-

✅ **LAST-MINUTE CHECKLIST (before leaving the hostel)**

- [] 🛂 **Passport + Schengen visa sticker** (valid through Sep 5) — on you, not in stored bag
 - [] 📱 **QR boarding pass saved offline** + booking screenshot
 - [] 📄 **Onward/return proof** accessible for passport control
 - [] 🧳 **All bags out of storage at 16:45** — double-check the locker/room, nothing left behind
 - [] 🔌 **Chargers + power bank + phone fully charged** (late boarding, QR needed)
 - [] 💶 **Spend / keep small euro cash** — you won't need euros after tonight; keep a little for airport water
 - [] 🍽️ **Veg meal confirmed** on booking + backup snack packed
 - [] 🏠 **Room swept** — passport, wallet, chargers, adapter, no forgotten items
 - [] ☔ **Light rain jacket handy** — leave nothing to weather on exit day
-

🎬 **Movies, Songs & Pop Culture Here (Bollywood + Hollywood)**

- 🇮🇳 **Amsterdam on Bollywood's map** — the city's canals, bridges and bicycle lanes have long been a **Hindi-cinema favourite** for romantic song sequences; the picture-postcard **canal-ring and Nine Streets** you'll stroll this morning are exactly the kind of backdrop those numbers use.
 - 🎬 **Hollywood — Amsterdam (2022, Christian Bale, Margot Robbie, John David Washington)** takes its very name and spirit from the city; *The Fault in Our Stars* (2014) famously sends its leads on a canal-boat, Anne Frank House romance through Amsterdam's waterways — the same canal-ring you're walking.
 - 🗼 **A'DAM Lookout & the north bank** — the modern **A'DAM Tower / "Over the Edge"** swing and the industrial **NDSM wharf** across the IJ are regular stops for **music videos and travel films** chasing Amsterdam's skyline.
 - 🎨 **Golden-Age thread continues** — after yesterday's Vermeer trail (Delft → the *Girl with a Pearl Earring* in The Hague), Amsterdam closes it with **Rembrandt's Amsterdam** (the Rijksmuseum's *Night Watch*) — the city that anchors nearly every Dutch-master film.
-

✅ ONE-LINE SUMMARY

Light Amsterdam morning — A'DAM swing, Albert Cuyp, Nine Streets, souvenirs, final veg lunch — **grab bags at 16:45** (the anchor), ~15-min OVpay train to Schiphol by **~17:30**, evening **non-stop to Mumbai, dep 20:35, arrive ~09:20 Sep 6**. Visa exit day — the flight is sacred. 🇳🇱 → 🇮🇳

🎬 *Film-location thread runs through the trip · full repo: github.com/divyanshh/trip*